

The UK Field Guide

Photograph a plant, insect, bird, or fungus, and chat about what it is and what to do.

Conclusively identified as Scandosorbus intermedia!

Classification result (scientific name, common name, confidence %)

1. Scandosorbus intermedia (Swedish Whitebeam)	63.7%
2. Hedlundia mougeotii (Mougeot's Whitebeam)	28.9%
3. Hedlundia hybrida (Swedish Service-tree)	2.8%

► Show thinking (5 steps)

Scandosorbus intermedia

Description: Scandosorbus intermedia, commonly known as the false medlar, is characterized by its simple, glabrous leaves and pink flowers with erect sepals and petals. It is primarily found in the mountainous regions of southern Europe.

Uses: This species is often cultivated as an ornamental tree in parks and gardens, and it has given rise to several cultivars recognized for their aesthetic appeal.

Conservation Status in the UK

According to the available information, **Scandosorbus intermedia** does not have an explicit conservation status in the UK. Additionally, it is not considered invasive in the region.

Recommendations

Since there is no specific conservation concern or invasive status associated with Scandosorbus intermedia in the UK, you can cultivate or enjoy this species without special considerations. However, as with any plant, it's always good practice to monitor its growth and impact on local ecosystems.

🚫 **This may be a regionally invasive species** — check local reporting/disposal rules before doing anything with it.

Sources:

- A Handbook of the British Flora, 1887 (George Bentham, 1858.) — <https://archive.org/details/handbookofbrit00bent>
- A Manual of British Botany, Royal College of Physicians of London. n 80046799, 1837 (Charles Cardale Babington, 19th-century UK flora reference.) — <https://archive.org/details/b28038824>
- The British Herbal (John Hill), Hill, John, 1714?-1775, 1756 (18th-century medicinal plant guide.) — https://archive.org/details/b30450950_0002
- The English Flora, Smith, James Edward, Sir, 1759-1828, [182 (James Edward Smith, 4 volumes, 1824-1828.) — <https://archive.org/details/englishflorasje01smit>
- Wikipedia, "Sorbus" — <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sorbus>

What is the scientific name of the Swedish whitebeam and where is it found?

► Show thinking (3 steps)

Sorbus hybrida (Swedish Whitebeam)

Scientific Name: Sorbus hybrida

Distribution: The Swedish whitebeam is primarily found in southern Sweden, with scattered occurrences in Estonia, Latvia, easternmost Denmark (Bornholm), the far southwest of Finland, and northern Poland. It also occurs in England.

Habitat: Sorbus hybrida typically grows in woodland areas and is adapted to cooler temperate climates. It thrives in well-drained soils and can often be found in mixed forests.

This species is a medium-sized deciduous tree, reaching heights of 10–20 meters (33–66 feet) with a stout trunk and a dome-shaped crown. The leaves are distinctive, being green above and densely hairy with pale grey-white hairs beneath, which contributes to its identification.

Sources:

- The British Herbal (John Hill), Hill, John, 1714?-1775, 1756 (18th-century medicinal plant guide.) — https://archive.org/details/b30450950_0002
- Wikipedia, "Hedlundia intermedia" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hedlundia_intermedia
- Wikipedia, "Sorbus" — <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sorbus>

What family does it belong to?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

Sorbus hybrida, commonly known as the Swedish whitebeam, belongs to the **Rosaceae** family, which is commonly referred to as the rose family. This family includes a wide variety of flowering plants, encompassing many economically important species, such as fruits and ornamental plants.

Sources:

- The British Herbal (John Hill), Hill, John, 1714?-1775, 1756 (18th-century medicinal plant guide.) — https://archive.org/details/b30450950_0002
- Wikipedia, "Rosaceae" — <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rosaceae>
- Wikipedia, "Sorbus" — <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sorbus>

How tall does it grow and what does its trunk look like?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

Sorbus hybrida, or the Swedish whitebeam, is a medium-sized deciduous tree that typically grows to a height of **10 to 20 meters** (approximately 33 to 66 feet). The trunk is described as **stout**, usually reaching up to **60 cm** (about 24 inches) in diameter, but it can sometimes be as wide as **2 to 3 meters** (6.6 to 9.8 feet). The bark is grey in color, contributing to its distinctive appearance. The crown of the tree is dome-shaped, supported by stout horizontal branches.

Sources:

- The British Herbal (John Hill), Hill, John, 1714?-1775, 1756 (18th-century medicinal plant guide.) — https://archive.org/details/b30450950_0002
- The Flowering Plants of Great Britain, 1905 (Anne Pratt, 6 volumes, 1855-1873 (also known as The Flowering Plants, Grasses, Sedges, and Ferns of Great Britain). Replaces unresolvable author placeholder.) — <https://archive.org/details/floweringplantsg01prat>
- Wikipedia, "Hedlundia intermedia" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hedlundia_intermedia
- Wikipedia, "Sorbus" — <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sorbus>

What shape is the crown?

The crown of Sorbus hybrida, or the Swedish whitebeam, is described as **dome-shaped**. This characteristic shape contributes to the tree's overall appearance, making it visually distinctive among other tree species.

What do the leaves look like?

The leaves of Sorbus hybrida, or the Swedish whitebeam, are distinctive in appearance. They are **green on the upper side** and **densely hairy with pale grey-white hairs on the underside**. This contrast in coloration and texture makes the leaves easily identifiable.

What color do the leaves turn in autumn?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

In autumn, the leaves of Sorbus hybrida (Swedish whitebeam) turn to a **dull yellowish to grey-brown** color. This change adds to the tree's seasonal appeal as it transitions from the vibrant greens of summer.

Sources:

- British Trees and Shrubs, Bean, W. J. (William Jackson), 1863-1947, 1916 (Published by the Tree Council; covers all common ornamental and native trees in the UK.) — <https://archive.org/details/treesshrubshardy01beanrich>
- The British Herbal (John Hill), Hill, John, 1714?-1775, 1756 (18th-century medicinal plant guide.) — https://archive.org/details/b30450950_0002
- The Flowering Plants of Great Britain, 1905 (Anne Pratt, 6 volumes, 1855-1873 (also known as The Flowering Plants, Grasses, Sedges, and Ferns of Great Britain). Replaces unresolvable author placeholder.) — <https://archive.org/details/floweringplantsg01prat>
- Wikipedia, "Hedlundia intermedia" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hedlundia_intermedia
- Wikipedia, "Sorbus" — <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sorbus>

What do the flowers look like?

► Show thinking (2 steps)

The flowers of Sorbus hybrida (Swedish whitebeam) are **15–20 mm in diameter**, featuring **five white petals** and approximately **20 yellowish-white stamens**. They are produced in corymbs that measure **8–12 cm in diameter** and typically bloom in late spring. This floral arrangement contributes to the tree's ornamental appeal.

Sources:

- The British Herbal (John Hill), Hill, John, 1714?-1775, 1756 (18th-century medicinal plant guide.) — https://archive.org/details/b30450950_0002
- Wikipedia, "Hedlundia intermedia" — https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hedlundia_intermedia
- Wikipedia, "Sorbus" — <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sorbus>

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